

AIF-C01: 30-Day Study Plan

PLAN C: 30-DAY COMPREHENSIVE PLAN

Assumptions

- Your exam is 15 to 30 days away.
- You can commit roughly 45-60 minutes on weekdays and 2-3 hours on weekends.
- The goal is deep understanding and confidence, with room for optional hands-on exploration in the AWS Management Console. This plan assumes a Monday start, with weekends falling on Days 6-7, 13-14, 20-21, and 27-28.

WEEK 1 (Days 1-7): Domains 1 and 2, Building the Foundation

Day	Theme	Daily Time	Materials	Flashcards (New/Review)	Practice Questions	Hands-On Suggestion (Optional, Free)
1	Domain 1, Task 1.1: Basic AI Concepts	45-60 min	Domain 1 Study Module, Task Statement 1.1	10 new / 0 review	3 (Domain 1 bank)	None needed yet; focus on vocabulary today.
2	Domain 1, Task 1.2: Practical Use Cases	45-60 min	Domain 1 Study Module, Task Statement 1.2	10 new / 10 review	3 (Domain 1 bank)	Open the Amazon Compre- hend console and run a sample sentiment- analysis request on a short piece of free-tier text.

Day	Theme	Daily Time	Materials	Flashcards (New/Review)	Practice Questions	Hands-On Suggestion (Optional, Free)
3	Domain 1, Task 1.3: AI/ML De- velopment Lifecycle	45-60 min	Domain 1 Study Module, Task Statement 1.3	10 new / 10 review	4 (remaining Domain 1 bank)	Browse the Amazon SageMaker AI console menu to see the major sections (Studio, training jobs, endpoints) without launching anything.
4	Domain 2, Task 2.1: GenAI Fun- damentals	45-60 min	Domain 2 Study Module, Task Statement 2.1	10 new / 15 review	4 (Domain 2 bank)	None needed; focus on tokens, em- beddings, and agentic AI vocabulary.
5	Domain 2, Task 2.2: Capabilities and Limitations	45-60 min	Domain 2 Study Module, Task Statement 2.2	10 new / 15 review	4 (Domain 2 bank)	None needed; this is a conceptual, business- tradeoffs day.

Day	Theme	Daily Time	Materials	Flashcards (New/Review)	Practice Questions	Hands-On Suggestion (Optional, Free)
6	Domain 2, Task 2.3: AWS GenAI In- frastructure	2-3 hrs (weekend)	Domain 2 Study Module, Task Statement 2.3	15 new / 20 review	4 (remaining Domain 2 bank)	Log into the Amazon Bedrock console and browse the model catalog to see the range of available foundation models, without invoking any paid model calls.
7	Week 1 Review and Domain 1 Self- Assessment	2-3 hrs (weekend)	Domain 1 and Domain 2 Study Modules (skim review); Master Flashcard Deck (Domain 1 and 2 cards)	0 new / 30 review	10 (Domain 1 self- assessment, mixed)	None; this is a consoli- dation day.

Week 1 milestone (Day 7): Answer 10 Domain 1 practice questions cold, with no notes. Aim for 8 or more correct. If you score below 8, flag the specific topics you missed and add them to your Day 26 re-study list.

WEEK 2 (Days 8-14): Domain 3, Applications of Foundation Models

Domain 3 carries the most exam weight (28%) of any domain, so it gets the most calendar time in this plan: a full week.

Day	Theme	Daily Time	Materials	Flashcards (New/Review)	Practice Questions	Hands-On Suggestion (Optional, Free)
8	Task 3.1, Part A: FM Selection Criteria and Inference Parameters	45-60 min	Domain 3 Study Module, Task Statement 3.1 (selection criteria, tempera- ture, in- put/output limits)	10 new / 15 review	3 (Domain 3 bank)	In the Bedrock console, open the chat/text playground and experiment with the tempera- ture slider on a sample prompt (no cost for most free- tier-eligible models; check current pricing first).
9	Task 3.1, Part B: RAG and Vector Databases	45-60 min	Domain 3 Study Module, Task Statement 3.1 (RAG, Knowledge Bases)	10 new / 15 review	3 (Domain 3 bank)	Browse the “Knowledge Bases” section of the Bedrock console to see the setup screen and data-source options, without creating a live knowledge base.

Day	Theme	Daily Time	Materials	Flashcards (New/Review)	Practice Questions	Hands-On Suggestion (Optional, Free)
10	Task 3.1, Part C: Customiza- tion Tradeoffs and AI Agents	45-60 min	Domain 3 Study Module, Task Statement 3.1 (cus- tomization spectrum, agents)	10 new / 20 review	3 (remaining Domain 3, Task 3.1 bank)	Browse the “Agents” section of the Bedrock console to see how an agent is configured, without deploying one.
11	Task 3.2: Prompt Engineering Techniques and Risks	45-60 min	Domain 3 Study Module, Task Statement 3.2	15 new / 20 review	4 (Domain 3 bank)	Practice writing one zero-shot and one few-shot version of the same prompt in a text editor, comparing how the instructions differ.
12	Task 3.3: Training and Fine- Tuning	45-60 min	Domain 3 Study Module, Task Statement 3.3	15 new / 20 review	4 (Domain 3 bank)	None needed; this is a conceptual, process- oriented day.

Day	Theme	Daily Time	Materials	Flashcards (New/Review)	Practice Questions	Hands-On Suggestion (Optional, Free)
13	Task 3.4: Evaluating FM Performance	2-3 hrs (weekend)	Domain 3 Study Module, Task Statement 3.4	15 new / 25 review	8 (remaining Domain 3 bank, this clears the full Domain 3 bank)	Open the “Model evaluation” section of the Bedrock console to see what an automatic evaluation job setup looks like.
14	Week 2 Review and Domain 2-3 Combined Check	2-3 hrs (weekend)	Domain 3 Study Module (full skim); Master Flashcard Deck (Domain 3 cards)	0 new / 30 review	15 (Domain 2 and 3 combined, mixed)	None; this is a consoli- dation day.

Week 2 milestone (Day 14): Answer 15 questions combining Domain 2 and Domain 3. Aim for 11 or more correct. Review every miss before moving into Week 3, since Domain 3 concepts will reappear throughout the rest of the program.

WEEK 3 (Days 15-21): Domains 4 and 5, Plus Reference Materials Mastery

Day	Theme	Daily Time	Materials	Flashcards (New/Review)	Practice Questions	Hands-On Suggestion (Optional, Free)
15	Task 4.1: Responsible AI Features and Bias	45-60 min	Domain 4 Study Module, Task Statement 4.1	10 new / 25 review	4 (Domain 4 bank)	None needed; this is a principles- and- terminology day.

Day	Theme	Daily Time	Materials	Flashcards (New/Review)	Practice Questions	Hands-On Suggestion (Optional, Free)
16	Task 4.2: Trans- parency and Ex- plainability	45-60 min	Domain 4 Study Module, Task Statement 4.2	10 new / 25 review	3 (remaining Domain 4 bank)	Browse the “Model Cards” feature description in the SageMaker console doc- umentation pages (read-only; no need to create one).
17	Task 5.1: Securing AI Systems	45-60 min	Domain 5 Study Module, Task Statement 5.1	10 new / 25 review	4 (Domain 5 bank)	Open the IAM console and look at how roles and policies are structured (read-only browsing of an existing role is sufficient).
18	Task 5.2: Governance and Compliance	45-60 min	Domain 5 Study Module, Task Statement 5.2	10 new / 25 review	3 (remaining Domain 5 bank)	Open AWS Artifact and view the list of available compliance reports (no download required).
19	AWS Services Quick Reference Guide, Full Read	45-60 min	AWS Services Quick Reference Guide (entire document)	0 new / 30 review	None today (active recall instead)	None; today is a pure reference- review day.

Day	Theme	Daily Time	Materials	Flashcards (New/Review)	Practice Questions	Hands-On Suggestion (Optional, Free)
20	Master Glossary Review and Domain 4-5 Practice	2-3 hrs (weekend)	Master Glossary (self-quiz, do not just scan); Domain 4 and 5 practice banks	0 new / 35 review	7 (Domain 4 bank, remaining) + 7 (Domain 5 bank, remaining)	None; this is a review and practice day.
21	Mid-Point Readiness Check	2-3 hrs (weekend)	All five Study Modules (spot-check weak spots only); Visual Cheat Sheet (first skim)	0 new / 35 review	30 (mixed domains, propor- tional to exam weighting)	None; this is an assessment day.

Week 3 milestone (Day 21): Answer 30 mixed-domain questions, proportioned roughly to the real exam (about 6 from Domain 1, 7 from Domain 2, 8 from Domain 3, 4 from Domain 4, 4 from Domain 5, with the remainder mixed). Aim for 22 or more correct. This is your mid-point readiness signal: if you are well below this, slow down and add extra review days before Week 4 rather than rushing into full exams.

WEEK 4 (Days 22-30): Assessment and Exam Readiness

Day	Theme	Daily Time	Materials	Flashcards (New/Review)	Practice Questions
22	First Full Practice Exam	Extend to 90+ min today regardless of week- day/weekend	Full-Length Practice Exam (timed, 65 questions)	0 new / light review only	65 (the full exam)

Day	Theme	Daily Time	Materials	Flashcards (New/Review)	Practice Questions
23	Score Analysis and Targeted Weak-Area Re-Study	45-60 min	Answer Key and Rationale Guide; the Study Module section(s) tied to your weakest domain	0 new / 25 review (weak-area cards)	Re-attempt 10-15 missed questions after re-studying the rationale
24	Flashcard Comprehensive Review, Part 1	45-60 min	Master Flashcard Deck, Domains 1, 2, and 3 (roughly 100 cards)	0 new / ~100 review	None today (flashcards only)
25	Flashcard Comprehensive Review, Part 2	45-60 min	Master Flashcard Deck, Domains 4 and 5 (roughly 75 cards), plus continued weak-domain restudy	0 new / ~75 review	None today (flashcards only)
26	Domain Re-Study Based on Practice Exam Results	45-60 min	Whichever 1-2 Study Modules produced the most misses on Day 22	0 new / 30 review (targeted)	10 (targeted to weakest topics)
27	Second Full Practice Exam or Domain-Targeted Mini-Exam	2-3 hrs (weekend)	Full-Length Practice Exam (second attempt) or a 30-question mini-exam built from the Domain Practice Question Banks	0 new / light review only	65 (second full exam) or 30 (mini-exam)

Day	Theme	Daily Time	Materials	Flashcards (New/Review)	Practice Questions
28	Visual Cheat Sheet, First Full Read	2-3 hrs (weekend)	Visual Cheat Sheet (read start to finish, note any gaps); light flashcard cleanup on gap areas	0 new / 20 review (gap areas only)	None today
29	Final Flashcard Run and Cheat Sheet, Second Read	45-60 min	Master Flashcard Deck (full 175-card final pass); Visual Cheat Sheet (second read)	0 new / 175 review (full deck, fast pass)	None today
30	Exam Day	Morning only, light	Visual Cheat Sheet (morning scan only)	0 new / 0 review (just a glance, no drilling)	None; do not take new practice questions today

Week 4 milestones: - **Day 22:** First full exam benchmark. Record your score; this is your true starting baseline for the final stretch. - **Day 27:** Final exam benchmark. Aim for 47 or more correct out of 65 (about 72%, comfortably above the 700-of-1,000 scaled passing standard). If you are below this, use Days 28-29 to focus review time on your two weakest domains rather than spreading attention evenly.

If your exam is more than 30 days away: Follow the full 30-day plan once, then repeat Week 4 with a fresh set of practice questions from the Domain Practice Question Banks (skip questions you have already seen). Continue repeating Week 4 in 7-9 day cycles until your exam date arrives, always benchmarking with a full or partial timed exam at the end of each cycle.

Choosing Your Plan

Use this simple rule to pick your plan:

Time Until Your Exam	Recommended Plan
7 days or fewer	Plan A: 7-Day Crash Plan
8 to 14 days	Plan B: 14-Day Standard Plan
15 to 30 days	Plan C: 30-Day Comprehensive Plan
More than 30 days	Follow Plan C, then repeat Week 4 with fresh practice questions until your exam date

If you are unsure which bucket you fall into, round down. It is far better to finish a shorter plan with a few spare days for rest than to run out of time partway through a longer plan.

Five Universal Study Habits

These five habits apply no matter which plan you are following.

1. Use Spaced Repetition With the Flashcards

Spaced repetition means reviewing material at increasing intervals instead of cramming it all at once, and it is one of the most well-supported techniques for long-term retention. In practice, that means every day you should: add your new cards for the day, review yesterday's cards in full, and spot-check a handful of cards from roughly a week ago. The day-by-day tables above build this rhythm in for you automatically. Trust the process even when a review session feels repetitive. The repetition is the point.

2. Never Just Check the Answer on a Missed Question

When you get a practice question wrong, resist the urge to glance at the correct letter and move on. Instead, read the full explanation in the Answer Key and Rationale Guide (or the rationale provided with each Domain Practice Question Bank item), and then write one sentence in your own words explaining why you chose the wrong answer. This single habit, more than any other, is what separates learners who plateau from learners who keep improving through every practice session.

3. Use the Cheat Sheet on a Schedule, Not Just at the End

The Visual Cheat Sheet is most useful when you treat it as a preview-and-recap tool rather than a last-minute panic document. Read it once at the very start of your plan (Day 1 or Day 2) so you know what is coming. Read it again at the midpoint of your plan to see how much more familiar it feels. Then read it twice more in your final three days before the exam. By the fourth read, it should feel like a list of old friends rather than a wall of new facts.

4. Apply the “Explain It to Someone” Test

For any concept you have just studied, try to explain it out loud, in plain English, to a non-technical colleague, a family member, or even an empty room. If you stumble, hedge, or fall back on jargon you cannot unpack, that is a clear signal the concept needs more study time. This test works because the AIF-C01 exam is explicitly designed for people who can have informed conversations about AI with technical teams and explain AI concepts clearly to others. If you can teach it simply, you can recognize it on the exam.

5. Treat Your Preparation as Your Anxiety Medicine

Some nervousness before a certification exam is normal and does not mean you are unprepared. The most reliable cure for exam-day anxiety is not a relaxation trick; it is the knowledge that you have already followed a structured plan, taken at least one full timed practice exam, and reviewed your weak areas with intention. When you feel a wave of doubt on exam day, remind yourself specifically

what you did to prepare (which plan, how many practice questions, what your benchmark score was) rather than reaching for a vague reassurance. Specific preparation produces specific confidence.

20-Item Exam Readiness Checklist

Work through this list honestly in the final days before your exam. Check off an item only when you can truly say yes without hesitating or needing to look anything up.

- ☐ I can name all 5 domains and their exam weights from memory.
- ☐ I can explain the difference between RAG and fine-tuning in one sentence.
- ☐ I know which Amazon Q variant or AWS developer tool fits which business scenario.
- ☐ I can name at least 5 Amazon Bedrock features and what each one does.
- ☐ I know the 6 features of responsible AI: bias, fairness, inclusivity, robustness, safety, and veracity.
- ☐ I can name 4 types or sources of AI bias and give an example of each.
- ☐ I know the difference between Amazon SageMaker Clarify and Amazon Augmented AI (A2I).
- ☐ I understand what the AWS Shared Responsibility Model means differently for Amazon Bedrock versus Amazon SageMaker AI.
- ☐ I know what AWS CloudTrail records versus what Amazon CloudWatch monitors versus what AWS Config tracks.
- ☐ I can explain hallucination and name at least 3 ways to reduce or detect it.
- ☐ I know when to reach for prompt engineering versus RAG versus fine-tuning for a given business need.
- ☐ I understand tokens and context windows at a conceptual level, including how they affect cost.
- ☐ I know what Amazon Macie protects against and what Amazon Bedrock Guardrails protects against.
- ☐ I scored 73% or higher (47 out of 65) on a full timed practice exam at least once.
- ☐ I have reviewed all 175 flashcards in the Master Flashcard Deck at least once.
- ☐ I understand the difference between explainability and interpretability.
- ☐ I know what Amazon SageMaker Model Monitor detects (data drift and model drift in production).
- ☐ I can describe what Amazon Bedrock Agents do in plain English, with a business example.
- ☐ I have identified my single weakest domain and given it extra, targeted review time.
- ☐ I have read the Visual Cheat Sheet at least twice.

If you cannot check every box, that is normal and does not mean you will fail. It does mean you know exactly where to spend any remaining study time you have left. Prioritize the unchecked items in the order they appear on this list; it is roughly sequenced from broad conceptual understanding toward specific service-level detail.

End of Learner Study Plans Reference: AWS Certified AI Practitioner (AIF-C01) Exam Guide, Version 1.1 (April 30, 2026) Companion document to the Master Project Blueprint